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Logical channel management for multiple eSIM profiles

Abstract

Techniques for managing logical channel communication for multiple electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) profiles installed on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC), including mapping of logical channel identifier values between different logical channel labeling schemes are described herein. In a first scheme, logical channels are identified using logical channel values alone. In a second scheme, logical channels are identified using a combination of eSIM port value and channel values. An interpreter in the eUICC and/or in processing circuitry external to the eUICC can map between the logical channel labeling schemes to allow internal state machines in the eUICC and/or the processing circuitry to use the first scheme for identifying logical channels.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/174,462, entitled “LOGICAL CHANNEL MANAGEMENT FOR MULTIPLE ENABLED eSIM PROFILES,” filed Apr. 13, 2021, the content of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

FIELD

(1) The described embodiments set forth techniques for managing logical channel communication

for multiple electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) profiles on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC), including mapping of logical channel identifier values between different logical channel labeling schemes.

BACKGROUND

(2) Wireless mobile network operators (MNOs) continue to upgrade wireless networks to support newer wireless communication standards, including fourth generation (4G) Long Term Evolution (LTE) and Long Term Evolution Advanced (LTE-A) technologies as well as fifth generation (5G) technologies. Wireless devices continue to evolve to incorporate newer, configurable wireless credentials, such as eSIMs that can be loaded to and subsequently activated on an eUICC of a wireless device. To support newer 5G wireless communication standards, specifications for eSIMs for 5G enabled wireless devices are being developed. With downloadable eSIMs becoming available to provide ready access to various wireless services, use of multiple eSIMs on a wireless device, including concurrent use of multiple eSIMs on an eUICC of a wireless device is proposed. Communication between the eUICC of a wireless device and a processor external to the eUICC is managed using logical channels. Different schemes are proposed for labeling multiple logical channels for communicating with multiple eSIMs installed on an eUICC of a wireless device.

SUMMARY

(3) Representative embodiments set forth techniques for managing logical channel communication for multiple electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) profiles on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC), including mapping of logical channel identifier values between different logical channel labeling schemes. With downloadable eSIMs becoming available to provide ready access to various wireless services, use of multiple eSIMs on a wireless device, including concurrent use of multiple eSIMs on an eUICC of a wireless device, is proposed. Communication between the eUICC of a wireless device and a processor external to the eUICC is managed using logical channels. Different schemes are proposed for labeling multiple logical channels for communicating with multiple eSIMs installed on the eUICC of a wireless device. In a first scheme, multiplexing among logical channels associated with multiple installed eSIMs uses unique logical channel values for each logical channel. In a second scheme, multiplexing among the logical channels is based on a combination of assigned eSIM port values and logical channel values. An eSIM can be assigned (or de-assigned) an eSIM port value using an application protocol data unit (APDU) command, such as a MANAGE PORT APDU command or a MANAGE UICC Logical Interface (ULI) APDU command. Multiple logical channels can be associated with the same eSIM port value for a given eSIM, with each logical channel associated with a particular eSIM port value having a distinct channel value. Identical channel values, e.g., channel “X”, can be used concurrently for distinct logical channels that are associated with different installed eSIMs. In each scheme, logical channels are uniquely identifiable, and communication messages to and from an installed eSIM includes the uniquely identifiable logical channel values. With the first scheme, logical channels are identified using the logical channel value alone. With the second scheme, logical channels are identified using a combination of eSIM port value and channel values. To manage logical channel communication using either scheme, a processor of a wireless device, which implements a terminal function with logical channels internally identified by the first scheme that uses unique logical channel values only, can include an interpreter function to map between the internal unique logical channel values and external logical channel values that use the second scheme with combinations of eSIM port values and logical channel values. Alternatively and/or additionally, an eUICC that uses internal unique logical channel values can communicate with an external processor that uses the first scheme by re-using the internal unique logical channel values to identify logical channels externally for communication with the external processor. The eUICC can also communicate with an external processor that uses the second scheme to identify logical channels by including an interpreter that maps the internal logical channel values to external logical channel values that use the second scheme with combinations of eSIM port values and

logical channel values to identify the logical channels externally for communication with the external processor. Logical channel mapping, implemented on the eUICC or on the external processor, can be used to communicate with multiple installed eSIMs, including eSIMs in an enabled state or in a disabled state.

(4) This Summary is provided merely for purposes of summarizing some example embodiments so as to provide a basic understanding of some aspects of the subject matter described herein.

Accordingly, it will be appreciated that the above-described features are merely examples and should not be construed to narrow the scope or spirit of the subject matter described herein in any way. Other features, aspects, and advantages of the subject matter described herein will become apparent from the following Detailed Description, Figures, and Claims.

(5) Other aspects and advantages of the embodiments described herein will become apparent from the following detailed description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings which illustrate, by way of example, the principles of the described embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The included drawings are for illustrative purposes and serve only to provide examples of possible structures and arrangements for the disclosed inventive apparatuses and methods for providing wireless computing devices. These drawings in no way limit any changes in form and detail that may be made to the embodiments by one skilled in the art without departing from the spirit and scope of the embodiments. The embodiments will be readily understood by the following detailed description in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numerals designate like structural elements.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of different components of an exemplary system configured to implement the various techniques described herein, according to some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of a more detailed view of exemplary components of the system of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

(4) FIGS. 3A and 3B illustrate exemplary schemes for uniquely labeling logical channels for communicating through an interface between an eUICC and external processing circuitry, according to some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 3C illustrates an exemplary correspondence table mapping functions provided by a logical channel to different logical channel value assignments based on the schemes illustrated in FIGS. 3A and 3B, according to some embodiments.

(6) FIGS. 4A, 4B, and 4C illustrate exemplary mappings of logical channel values between the schemes illustrated in FIGS. 3A and 3B, according to some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 4D illustrates a table of an exemplary logical channel interpreter mapping that can be used for the schemes illustrated in FIGS. 4B and 4C, according to some embodiments.

(8) FIG. 5 illustrates a flow diagram of an exemplary sequence of actions by an apparatus of a wireless device for managing logical channel values with multiple installed eSIMs, according to some embodiments.

(9) FIG. 6 illustrates a detailed view of a representative computing device that can be used to implement various methods described herein, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Representative applications of apparatuses and methods according to the presently described embodiments are provided in this section. These examples are being provided solely to add context and aid in the understanding of the described embodiments. It will thus be apparent to one skilled in the art that the presently described embodiments can be practiced without some or all of these specific details. In other instances, well known process steps have not been described in detail in

order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring the presently described embodiments. Other applications are possible, such that the following examples should not be taken as limiting.

(11) Representative embodiments set forth techniques for managing logical channel communication for multiple electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) profiles installed on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC), including mapping of logical channel identifier values between different logical channel labeling schemes. With downloadable eSIMs becoming available to provide ready access to various wireless services, use of multiple eSIMs on a wireless device, including concurrent use of multiple eSIMs on an eUICC of a wireless device, is proposed. Communication between the eUICC of a wireless device and a processor external to the eUICC is managed using logical channels. Different schemes are proposed for labeling the multiple logical channels when multiple eSIMs are installed concurrently on an eUICC of a wireless device. In a first scheme, multiplexing among logical channels associated with multiple, concurrently installed eSIMs uses unique logical channel values for each logical channel. In a second scheme, multiplexing among the logical channels is based on a combination of assigned eSIM port values and logical channel values. An eSIM can be assigned (or de-assigned) an eSIM port value using an application protocol data unit (APDU) command, such as a MANAGE PORT APDU command or a MANAGE ULI APDU command. Multiple logical channels can be associated with the same eSIM port value for a given eSIM, with each logical channel associated with a particular eSIM port value having a distinct channel value. Identical channel values, e.g., channel “X”, can be used concurrently for distinct logical channels that are associated with different eSIMs installed on an eUICC. In each scheme, logical channels are uniquely identifiable, and communication messages to and from an eSIM includes the uniquely identifiable logical channel values. With the first scheme, logical channels are identified using the logical channel value alone. With the second scheme, logical channels are identified using a combination of eSIM port value and logical channel value. To manage logical channel communication using either scheme, a processor of a wireless device, which implements a terminal function with logical channels internally identified by the first scheme that uses unique logical channel values only, can include an interpreter function to map between the internal unique logical channel values and external logical channel values that use the second scheme with combinations of eSIM port values and logical channel values. Alternatively and/or additionally, an eUICC that uses internal unique logical channel values can communicate with an external processor that uses the first scheme by re-using the internal unique logical channel values to identify logical channels externally for communication with the external processor. The eUICC can also communicate with an external processor that uses the second scheme to identify logical channels by including an interpreter that maps the internal logical channel values to external logical channel values that use the second scheme with combinations of eSIM port values and logical channel values to identify the logical channels externally for communication with the external processor. Logical channel mapping, implemented on the eUICC or on the external processor, can be used to communicate with multiple installed eSIMs, including eSIMs in an enabled state or in a disabled state.

(12) These and other embodiments are discussed below with reference to FIGS. 1 through 6; however, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that the detailed description given herein with respect to these figures is for explanatory purposes only and should not be construed as limiting.

(13) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of different components of a system 100 that is configured to implement the various techniques described herein, according to some embodiments. More specifically, FIG. 1 illustrates a high-level overview of the system 100, which, as shown, includes a user equipment (UE) 102, a group of base stations 112-1 to 112-n that are managed by different Mobile Network Operators (MNOs) 114, and a set of provisioning servers 116 that are in communication with the MNOs 114. The UE 102 can represent a mobile computing device (e.g., an iPhone® or an iPad® by Apple®), the base stations 112-1 to 112-n can represent cellular wireless

network entities including evolved NodeBs (eNBs) and/or next generation NodeBs (gNBs or gNB) that are configured to communicate with the UE **102**, and the MNOs **114** can represent different wireless service providers that provide specific services (e.g., voice and data) to which the UE **102** can be subscribed. The UE **102** may also be referred to as a wireless device, a mobile device, a mobile wireless device, or the like.

(14) As shown in FIG. **1**, the UE **102** can include processing circuitry, which can include one or more processors **104** and memory **106**, an embedded Universal Integrated Circuit Card (eUICC) **108**, and a baseband component **110**. In some embodiments, the UE **102** includes one or more physical UICC cards, also referred to as Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) cards (not shown), in addition to or substituting for the eUICC. The components of the UE **102** work in conjunction to enable the UE **102** to provide useful features to a user of the UE **102**, such as localized computing, location-based services, and Internet connectivity. The eUICC **108** can be configured to store multiple electronic SIMs (eSIMs) for accessing different services offered by one or more MNOs **114** through base stations **112-1** to **112-n**. For example, the eUICC **108** can be configured to store and manage one or more eSIMs for one or more MNOs **114** for different subscriptions to which the UE **102** has been associated. To be able to access services provided by the MNOs, an eSIM can be provisioned to the eUICC **108**. In some embodiments, the eUICC **108** obtains one or more eSIMs (or updates for one or more eSIMs) from one or more associated provisioning servers **116**. It is noted that provisioning servers **116** can be maintained by a manufacturer of the UE **102**, the MNOs **114**, third party entities, and the like. Communication of eSIM data between a provisioning server **116** and the eUICC **108** (or between the provisioning server **116** and processing circuitry of the UE **102** external to the eUICC **108**, e.g., the processor **104**) can use a secure communication channel. Multiple eSIMs can be downloaded to the eUICC **108** of the UE **102** from one or more provisioning servers **116** associated with one or more MNOs **114**. The UE **102** can be configured to allow for multiple eSIMs to be enabled concurrently on the UE **102** to provide access to wireless services provided by the multiple eSIMs. Communication between the multiple eSIMs installed on the eUICC **108** and circuitry external to the eUICC **108**, e.g., to a processor **104** and/or to the baseband component **110** can use one or more distinct logical channels for each installed eSIM on the eUICC **108**. Communication can occur with installed eSIMs that are in an enabled state or in a disabled state.

(15) FIG. **2** illustrates a block diagram of a more detailed view **200** of particular components of the UE **102** of FIG. **1**, according to some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **2**, the processor(s) **104**, in conjunction with the memory **106**, can implement a main operating system (OS) **202** that is configured to execute applications **204** (e.g., native OS applications and user applications). As also shown in FIG. **2**, the eUICC **108** can be configured to implement an eUICC OS **206** that is configured to manage the hardware resources of the eUICC **108** (e.g., a processor and a memory embedded in the eUICC **108**). The eUICC OS **206** can also be configured to manage eSIMs **208** that are stored by the eUICC **108**, e.g., by installing, enabling, disabling, modifying, or otherwise performing management of the eSIMs **208** within the eUICC **108** and providing the baseband component **110** with access to the eSIMs **208** to provide access to wireless services for the UE **102**. The eUICC **108** OS can include an eSIM manager **210**, which can perform management functions for various eSIMs. According to the illustration shown in FIG. **2**, each eSIM **208** can include a number of applets **212** that define the manner in which the eSIM **208** operates. For example, one or more of the applets **212**, when implemented by the baseband component **110** and the eUICC **108**, can be configured to enable the UE **102** to communicate with an MNO **114** and provide useful features (e.g., voice connections, messaging services, internet access and the like) to a user of the UE **102**.

(16) As also shown in FIG. **2**, the baseband component **110** of the UE **102** can include a baseband OS **214** that is configured to manage hardware resources of the baseband component **110** (e.g., a processor, a memory, different radio components, etc.). According to some embodiments, the

baseband component **110** can implement a baseband manager **216** that is configured to interface with the eUICC **108** to establish a secure channel with a provisioning server **116** and obtaining information (such as eSIM data) from the provisioning server **116** for purposes of managing eSIMs **208**. The baseband manager **216** can be configured to implement services **218**, which represents a collection of software modules that are instantiated by way of the various applets **212** of enabled eSIMs **208** that are included in the eUICC **108**. For example, services **218** can be configured to manage different connections between the UE **102** and MNOs **114** according to the different eSIMs **208** that are enabled within the eUICC **108**.

(17) FIG. 3A illustrates a block diagram **300** of a first scheme for uniquely labeling logical channels for communicating through an ISO interface **304** between an eUICC **108** and a terminal **302**, which can be implemented in processing circuitry of the UE **102** external to the eUICC **108**. Each internal logical channel operating within the terminal **302** is associated with a unique logical channel identifier value. A single logical channel using channel identifier value 2 (CH2) is used for communication between the terminal **302** and a root issuer security domain (ISD-R) in the eUICC **108**. A set of three logical channels using channel identifier values 0, 1, and 3 (CH0, CH1, CH3) are used for communication between the terminal **302** and a first eSIM profile (Profile A). A first logical channel using channel identifier value 0 (CH0) is used for communication with the SIM application toolkit (STK) of eSIM Profile A. A second logical channel using logical channel identifier value 1 (CH1) is used for communication with a USIM application of eSIM profile A, while a third logical channel using logical channel identifier 2 (CH2) is used for communication with an ISIM application of eSIM profile A. Similarly, a second set of three logical channels using channel identifier values 4, 5, and 6 (CH4, CH5, CH6) are used for communication between the terminal **302** and the STK, a USIM application, and an ISIM application of a second eSIM profile (Profile B) on the eUICC **108**. Each logical channel traversing the ISO interface **304** between the terminal **302** and the eUICC **108** is assigned a unique logical channel value. In some embodiments, a maximum number of logical channel values are allowed, e.g., a total of no more than 20 logical channels assigned concurrently. The use of the STK, the USIM application, and the ISIM application is solely provided as examples of functional elements operating with the eSIM profile that can be associated with a logical channel for communication with an external processor, e.g., terminal **302**. As shown in FIG. 3A, each logical channel is assigned a uniquely identifiable logical channel identifier value. Messages communicated via the ISO interface **304** between the terminal **302** and the eUICC **108** can include the uniquely identifiable logical channel identifier values to allow the receiving entity (terminal **302** or eUICC **108**) to identify an intended recipient of a message.

(18) FIG. 3B illustrates a block diagram **310** of a second scheme for uniquely labeling logical channels for communicating through the ISO interface **304** between the eUICC **108** and the terminal **302** of the UE **102**. In the second scheme, logical channels associated with a given eSIM profile are grouped together using an eSIM Port value. Each eSIM profile on the eUICC **108** can be assigned (or de-assigned) a unique eSIM port value using an application protocol data unit (APDU) command, such as a MANAGE PORT APDU command or a MANAGE ULI APDU command. Each distinct eSIM port can support one or more distinct logical channels up to a maximum allowable number per eSIM port. Each internal logical channel operating within the terminal **302** can be associated with a unique identifier value using a combination of an eSIM Port value and a logical channel value. A single logical channel, using the combination of eSIM Port value 0 (P0) and channel identifier value 2 (CH0), represented as the set identifier value {P0, CH0}, is used for communication between the terminal **302** and the ISD-R in the eUICC **108**. A set of three logical channels using eSIM Port value 1 (P1) and channel identifier values 0, 1, and 2 (CH0, CH1, CH2) are used for communication between the terminal **302** and Profile A. A first logical channel associated with eSIM Port value 1 and channel identifier value 0 (CH0) is used for communication with the STK of eSIM Profile A. A second logical channel associated with eSIM Port value 1 and

channel identifier value 1 (CH1) is used for communication with the USIM application of eSIM profile A, while a third logical channel associated eSIM Port value 1 and channel identifier 2 (CH2) is used for communication with the ISIM application of eSIM profile A. Similarly, a second set of three logical channels associated with eSIM Port value 2 and channel identifier values 0, 1, and 2 (CH0, CH1, CH2) are used for communication between the terminal **302** and the STK, the USIM application, and the ISIM application of Profile B on the eUICC **108**. Each logical channel traversing the ISO interface **304** between the terminal **302** and the eUICC **108** is assigned a unique logical channel value based on a combination of the eSIM Port value and the channel value. In some embodiments, a maximum number of logical channel values are allowed, e.g., a total of no more than 20 logical channels can be assigned concurrently, for each eSIM Port value. As shown in FIG. **3B**, each logical channel is assigned a uniquely identifiable logical channel identifier value represented as the set {eSIM Port value, Channel value}. Messages communicated via the ISO interface **304** between the terminal **302** and the eUICC **108** can include the uniquely identifiable logical channel identifier values, e.g., the combinations of an eSIM Port value and a Channel value, to allow the receiving entity (terminal **302** or eUICC **108**) to identify an intended recipient of a message. Additionally and/or alternatively, messages communicated via the ISO interface **304** between the terminal **302** and the eUICC **108** can be preceded by one or more APDU commands, such as MANAGE PORT APDU commands or MANAGE ULI APDU commands, where the APDU commands include uniquely identifiable eSIM Port values of messages that follow the APDU commands.

(19) FIG. **3C** illustrates a correspondence table **320** that maps functions provided by a logical channel to different logical channel value assignments based on the schemes illustrated in FIGS. **3A** and **3B**. To access and communicate with an ISD-R on the eUICC **108**, messages can include a logical channel value, e.g., Channel 2, when using logical channel values only to distinguish among multiple logical channels as in FIG. **3A**, or an eSIM port value and channel value combination, e.g., {eSIM Port 0, Channel 0}, as in FIG. **3B**. Multiple logical channels can be assigned to multiple installed eSIMs **208**, with distinct logical channel values or eSIM port values in combination with channel values distinguishing among the logical channels for a given eSIM **208**. In some embodiments, channel value 0 in combination with eSIM port value 0 is reserved for access to the ISD-R of the eUICC **108**. In some embodiments, channel value 0 in combination with a non-zero eSIM port value is reserved for communication via a basic logical channel with the STK. In some embodiments, non-zero channel values in combination non-zero eSIM port values are used for communication with different eSIM applications, e.g., USIM and/or ISIM.

(20) FIG. **4A** illustrates a table **400** of a first exemplary mapping of logical channel values between the scheme of FIG. **3A** and the scheme of FIG. **3B**. Unlike the correspondence illustrated in FIG. **3C**, in which there is no relationship between the logical channel values of the scheme of FIG. **3A** and the eSIM port value and channel value combinations of FIG. **3B**, in the mapping shown in table **400**, the eSIM port value is re-used as the logical channel number. In this case, the eSIM port value 0 and the identical logical channel number 0 is reserved for access to the ISD-R of the eUICC **108**. Further, the basic channel used for STK communication with a given eSIM profile is associated with a logical channel value equal to the assigned eSIM port value, e.g., for eSIM profile A, an eSIM port value of “X” assigned in the scheme of FIG. **3B** is also used as the logical channel value for the same channel in the scheme of FIG. **3A**. Additional logical channel values for the scheme of FIG. **3A** are selected to be unique for communication across all eSIMs, while channel values for the scheme of FIG. **3B** can re-use channel values for communication with different eSIMs. In some embodiments, a value for an eSIM port can be returned when the eSIM port is opened, e.g., in a message communicated in response to a MANAGE PORT APDU command or a MANAGE ULI APDU command. In some embodiments, an eSIM port value and/or a logical channel value of an eSIM profile can be returned when a port is opened, e.g., via a MANAGE PORT APDU command or a MANAGE ULI APDU command, or when an eSIM profile is enabled,

e.g., in a message communicated in response to an Enable Profile command or a STORE DATA APDU command used to enable the eSIM profile.

(21) FIG. 4B illustrates a diagram **410** of another exemplary mapping of logical channel values between the logical channel value only based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3A used by a first local profile assistant (LPA) **414** function on processing circuitry external to the eUICC **108** and the combination of eSIM port value and channel value based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3B used by a second LPA **416** on the same (or different) processing circuitry external to the eUICC **108**. In some embodiments, the first LPA **414** can be a legacy, non-standardized (e.g., proprietary) LPA. In some embodiments, the second LPA **416** can be a standardized remote SIM provisioning (RSP) LPA. An interpreter **412** function can be implemented on the eUICC **108** to allow the eUICC **108** to use logical channel values on internal states in accordance with the logical channel value only based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3A and to map between the internal to the eUICC **108** logical channel values and the combination of eSIM port value and channel value used by the standardized scheme of FIG. 3B. When communicating via logical channels with the first LPA **414**, the eUICC **108** can use logical channel values in the messages to distinguish among multiple eSIMs **208** and ISD-R access. When communicating via logical channels with the second LPA **416**, the interpreter **412** of the eUICC **108** can map internal eUICC logical channel values to external {eSIM Port value, Channel value} combinations in the messages communicated via the external interface to distinguish among the multiple eSIMs **208** and ISD-R access. In some embodiments, a channel value used for the basic channel (STK function) defaults to a zero value, and the basic channel's assigned logical channel value need not be returned when opening an eSIM port for an eSIM **208**. The eUICC **108** of FIG. 4B manages two distinct interfaces depending on the type of LPA with which the eUICC **108** is interworking. In some embodiments, an interface of the eUICC **108** using logical channel values can communicate with the first LPA **414**, while another interface of the eUICC **108** can use the {eSIM Port value, Channel value} combinations to communicate with the second LPA **416**, e.g., with an RSP-compliant LPA or with a test platform that implements an RSP LPA.

(22) FIG. 4C illustrates a diagram **420** of a further exemplary mapping of logical channel values between the logical channel value only based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3A used for a first interface on a first eUICC **108A** and the combination of eSIM port value and channel value based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3B used by a second interface on a second eUICC **108B**. In some embodiments, the first interface of the first eUICC **108A** can be a legacy, non-standardized interface, e.g., a proprietary interface, while the second interface of the second eUICC **108B** can be a standardized RSP interface. In some embodiments, the first eUICC **108A** can operate, at least in part, based on one or more legacy, non-standardized, e.g., proprietary, protocols, while the second eUICC **108B** can operate, at least in part, based on one or more standardized RSP protocols. An interpreter **424** function can be implemented by an LPA **422** on processing circuitry external to the eUICCs **108A/108B** to allow the first eUICC **108A** to use logical channel values on internal states in accordance with the logical channel value only based multiplexing scheme of FIG. 3A and to allow the second eUICC **108B** to use the combination of eSIM port value and channel value for logical channel assignments based on the standardized scheme of FIG. 3B. The LPA **422** includes the interpreter **424** to map between internal logical channel values used on an internal state machine of the LPA **422** and the combination of eSIM Port and channel values used for external communication with the second eUICC **108B**. When communicating via logical channels with the first eUICC **108A**, the LPA **422** can use logical channel values in the messages to distinguish among multiple eSIMs **208** and ISD-R access. When communicating via logical channels with the second eUICC **108B**, the interpreter **424** of the LPA **422** can map internal LPA logical channel values to external {eSIM Port value, Channel value} combinations in the messages communicated via the external interface to distinguish among the multiple eSIMs **208** and ISD-R access. In some embodiments, a channel value used for the basic channel (STK function) defaults to a zero value,

and the basic channel's assigned logical channel value need not be returned when opening an eSIM port for an eSIM **208**. The eUICC **108** of FIG. **4B** manages two distinct interfaces depending on the type of LPA with which the eUICC **108** is interworking. In some embodiments, an interface that uses logical channel values only for distinguishing among logical channels can be used to communicate with the first eUICC **108A**, while another interface using the {eSIM Port value, Channel value} combinations to distinguish among different logical channels can be used to communicate with the second eUICC **108B**. In some embodiments, the second eUICC **108B** can be an RSP-compliant eUICC, which can be included in a test platform for testing the LPA **422**.

(23) FIG. **4D** illustrates a table **430** of an exemplary logical channel interpreter mapping that can be used for the schemes illustrated in FIGS. **4B** and **4C**. For access to an ISD-R of an eUICC **108**, an eSIM port number can be assigned a value of zero and a channel number can be fixed to use a value of zero for a logical channel associated with access to the ISD-R of the eUICC **108** via an RSP standardized interface. When accessing an ISD-R of an eUICC **108** via a legacy, logical channel number based interface, any numerical value can be assigned, e.g., a logical channel value of "Z" as shown. When communicating over a basic logical channel (STK access) of an eSIM profile, a zero-valued channel number can be used for the eSIM profile in combination with an assigned eSIM port value to identify the basic logical channel of the eSIM profile. The basic channel of each eSIM profile can use the same zero-valued channel number. A logical channel number used for a legacy, logical channel value only based interface, however, can be different for each eSIM profile. Logical channel values for the legacy interface must be distinct for each logical channel opened on the legacy interface. The logical channel values can be the same as the channel number values in some cases, e.g., when the channel number values are distinct as shown in FIG. **4D** for the non-basic logical channels, or can differ from the channel number values, such as when channel number values are re-used across different eSIM profiles as shown in FIG. **3C**.

(24) FIG. **5** illustrates a flowchart **500** of an exemplary method for managing logical channel values with multiple eSIMs, the method performed by an apparatus of a wireless device **102**. At **502**, the apparatus associates a first set of one or more logical channels for communication with a first eSIM **208** installed on an eUICC **108** of the wireless device **102**. At **504**, in some embodiments, the apparatus associates a second set of one or more logical channels for communication with a second eSIM **208** concurrently installed with the first eSIM **208** on the eUICC **108** of the wireless device **102**. At **506**, the apparatus maps a first message, received via a first external interface, to a first logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM **208**, where the first message includes an eSIM port value and a channel value to identify the first logical channel. At **508**, the apparatus maps a second message, received via a second external interface, to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM **208**, where the second message includes a logical channel value of the first set of one or more logical channels to identify the second logical channel.

(25) In some embodiments, the first and second external interfaces use a common physical interface; the physical interface is configured as the first external interface to use combinations of eSIM port values and channel values to identify distinct logical channels; and the physical interface is configured as the second external interface to use logical channel values only to identify distinct logical channels. In some embodiments, the apparatus includes an interpreter **412** functional block operating on the eUICC **108** of the wireless device **102**. In some embodiments, the apparatus includes an interpreter **424** functional block operating on an LPA **422** of the wireless device **102**. In some embodiments, the apparatus associates a second set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a second eSIM **208** concurrently installed with the first eSIM **208** on the eUICC **108** of the wireless device **102**, where each logical channel value in the first and second sets of one or more logical channel values are distinct. In some embodiments, the apparatus maps a second message, received via the first external interface, to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM **208**,

where the second message includes the eSIM port value (as in the first message and associated with the first eSIM **208**) and a second channel value to identify the second logical channel. In some embodiments, the apparatus associates a non-zero logical channel value with a second logical channel for communication with a root issuer security domain (ISD-R) of the eUICC **108**.

(26) FIG. **6** illustrates a detailed view of a representative computing device **600** that can be used to implement various methods described herein, according to some embodiments. In particular, the detailed view illustrates various components that can be included in the UE **102** illustrated in FIG. **1**. As shown in FIG. **6**, the computing device **600** can include a processor **602** that represents a microprocessor or controller for controlling the overall operation of computing device **600**. The computing device **600** can also include a user input device **608** that allows a user of the computing device **600** to interact with the computing device **600**. For example, the user input device **608** can take a variety of forms, such as a button, keypad, dial, touch screen, audio input interface, visual/image capture input interface, input in the form of sensor data, etc. Still further, the computing device **600** can include a display **610** that can be controlled by the processor **602** to display information to the user. A data bus **616** can facilitate data transfer between at least a storage device **640**, the processor **602**, and a controller **613**. The controller **613** can be used to interface with and control different equipment through and equipment control bus **614**. The computing device **600** can also include a network/bus interface **611** that couples to a data link **612**. In the case of a wireless connection, the network/bus interface **611** can include a wireless transceiver.

(27) The computing device **600** also includes a storage device **640**, which can comprise a single disk or a plurality of disks (e.g., hard drives), and includes a storage management module that manages one or more partitions within the storage device **640**. In some embodiments, storage device **640** can include flash memory, semiconductor (solid state) memory or the like. The computing device **600** can also include a Random Access Memory (RAM) **620** and a Read-Only Memory (ROM) **622**. The ROM **622** can store programs, utilities or processes to be executed in a non-volatile manner. The RAM **620** can provide volatile data storage, and stores instructions related to the operation of the computing device **600**. The computing device **600** can further include a secure element (SE) **650**, which can represent the eUICC **108** of the UE **102**.

(28) Wireless Technology

(29) In accordance with various embodiments described herein, the terms “wireless communication device,” “wireless device,” “mobile device,” “mobile station,” and “user equipment” (UE) may be used interchangeably herein to describe one, or any number of, common consumer electronic device(s) that may be capable of performing procedures associated various embodiments the disclosure. In accordance with various implementations, any one of these consumer electronic devices may relate to: a cellular phone or a smart phone, a tablet computer, a laptop computer or a netbook computer, a media player device, an electronic book device, a MiFi® device, a wearable computing device, as well as any other type of electronic computing device having fourth generation (4G) Long Term Evolution (LTE) and LTE Advanced (LTE-A), fifth generation (5G) new radio (NR), or similar “later generation” cellular wireless access communication capabilities.

(30) Additionally, it should be understood that the UEs described herein may be configured as multi-mode wireless devices that are also capable of communicating via legacy third generation (3G) and/or second generation (2G) RATs in addition to communicating with 4G wireless networks, as well as communicating using one or more different wireless local area networks. Multi-mode UEs can include support for communication in accordance with one or more different wireless communication protocols developed by standards bodies, e.g., 3GPP's Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM), Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), LTE, LTE-A, and 5G NR standards or 3GPP2's CDMA2000 (1×RTT, 2×EV-DO, HRPD, eHRPD) standards. Multi-mode UEs can also support communication using wireless local area networking protocols, e.g., the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11 (Wi-Fi), IEEE 802.16 (WiMAX), and wireless personal area networking protocols, e.g., Bluetooth®. Multiple

wireless communication protocols can provide complementary functions and/or different services for a multi-mode UE.

(31) It is well understood that the use of personally identifiable information should follow privacy policies and practices that are generally recognized as meeting or exceeding industry or governmental requirements for maintaining the privacy of users. In particular, personally identifiable information data should be managed and handled so as to minimize risks of unintentional or unauthorized access or use, and the nature of authorized use should be clearly indicated to users.

(32) The various aspects, embodiments, implementations or features of the described embodiments can be used separately or in any combination. Further, some aspects of the described embodiments may be implemented by software, hardware, or by a combination of hardware and software. The described embodiments can also be embodied as computer program code stored on a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The computer readable-medium may be associated with any data storage device that can store data, which can thereafter be read by a computer or a computer system. Examples of the computer-readable medium include read-only memory, random-access memory, CD-ROMs, Solid-State Disks (SSD or Flash), HDDs, DVDs, magnetic tape, and optical data storage devices. The computer-readable medium can also be distributed over network-coupled computer systems so that the computer program code may be executed in a distributed fashion.

(33) The foregoing description, for purposes of explanation, used specific nomenclature to provide a thorough understanding of the described embodiments. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that some of the specific details are not required in order to practice the described embodiments. Thus, the foregoing descriptions of specific embodiments are presented herein for purposes of illustration and description. These descriptions are not intended to be exhaustive, all-inclusive, or to limit the described embodiments to the precise forms or details disclosed. It will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that many modifications and variations are possible in view of the above teachings, without departing from the spirit and the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. An apparatus configured for operation in a wireless device, the apparatus comprising: at least one processor communicatively coupled to a memory storing instructions that, when executed by the at least one processor, configure the apparatus to: associate a first set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a first electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) installed on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC) of the wireless device; and map a first message, received via a first external interface, to a first logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the first message includes an eSIM port value and a channel value to identify the first logical channel, wherein: the first external interface is configured to use combinations of eSIM port values and channel values to identify distinct logical channels; a second external interface is configured to use logical channel values only to identify distinct logical channels; and the first and second external interfaces comprise a common physical interface.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the apparatus is further configured to: map a second message, received via the second external interface, to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the second message includes a logical channel value of the first set of one or more logical channel values to identify the second logical channel.
3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein: the first external interface connects the eUICC of the wireless device to a first local profile assistant (LPA) operating on a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second external interface connects the eUICC of the wireless device to a second local LPA operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device.

4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein: the first external interface connects a local profile assistant (LPA) operating on a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second external interface connects the LPA of the wireless device to a second eUICC of the wireless device.
5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the apparatus comprises an interpreter functional block operating on the eUICC of the wireless device.
6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the apparatus comprises an interpreter functional block of a local profile assistant (LPA) operating on a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device.
7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the apparatus is further configured to: associate a second set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a second eSIM concurrently installed with the first eSIM on the eUICC of the wireless device, wherein each logical channel value in the first and second sets of one or more logical channel values are distinct.
8. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the apparatus is further configured to: map a second message, received via the first external interface, to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the second message includes the eSIM port value and a second channel value to identify the second logical channel.
9. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the apparatus is further configured to: associate a non-zero logical channel value with a second logical channel for communication with a root issuer security domain (ISD-R) of the eUICC.
10. A method of wireless communication comprising: associating a first set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a first electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) installed on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC) of a wireless device; and mapping a first message to a first logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the first message includes an eSIM port value and a channel value to identify the first logical channel, wherein: combinations of eSIM port values and channel values identify distinct logical channels when communicated via a first interface between a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC and the eUICC; only logical channel values identify distinct logical channels when communicated via a second interface between the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC and the eUICC; and in a first configuration, the first and second interfaces comprise a common physical interface, or in a second configuration, the first and second interfaces each comprise distinct physical interfaces.
11. The method of claim 10, further comprising: mapping a second message to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the second message includes a logical channel value of the first set of one or more logical channel values to identify the second logical channel.
12. The method of claim 11, wherein: the first interface connects the eUICC to a first local profile assistant (LPA) operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second interface connects the eUICC of the wireless device to a second local LPA operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device.
13. The method of claim 10, wherein: the first interface connects a local profile assistant (LPA) operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second interface connects the LPA of the wireless device to a second eUICC of the wireless device.
14. The method of claim 10, wherein an interpreter functional block operates on the eUICC of the wireless device.
15. The method of claim 10, wherein an interpreter functional block of a local profile assistant (LPA) operates on a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device.

16. The method of claim 10, further comprising: associating a second set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a second eSIM concurrently installed with the first eSIM on the eUICC of the wireless device; and mapping a second message to a second logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the second message includes the eSIM port value and a second channel value to identify the second logical channel, wherein each logical channel value in the first and second sets of one or more logical channel values are distinct.

17. The method of claim 10, further comprising: associating a non-zero logical channel value with a second logical channel for communication with a root issuer security domain (ISD-R) of the eUICC.

18. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions that, when executed by one or more processors of a wireless device, cause the wireless device to: associate a first set of one or more logical channel values with one or more logical channels for communication with a first electronic subscriber identity module (eSIM) installed on an embedded universal integrated circuit card (eUICC) of the wireless device; and map a first message to a first logical channel of the one or more logical channels associated with the first eSIM, wherein the first message includes an eSIM port value and a channel value to identify the first logical channel, wherein: combinations of eSIM port values and channel values identify distinct logical channels when communicated via a first interface between a processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC and the eUICC; only logical channel values identify distinct logical channels when communicated via a second interface between the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC and the eUICC; and in a first configuration, the first and second interfaces comprise a common physical interface, or in a second configuration, the first and second interfaces each comprise distinct physical interfaces.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 18, wherein: the first interface connects the eUICC to a first local profile assistant (LPA) operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second interface connects the eUICC of the wireless device to a second local LPA operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC of the wireless device.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 18, wherein: the first interface connects a local profile assistant (LPA) operating on the processor of the wireless device external to the eUICC to the eUICC of the wireless device; and the second interface connects the LPA of the wireless device to a second eUICC of the wireless device.
